

J.D. Roth was one of the first successful personal finance bloggers. He's now part of the FI community, but he didn't start there. Roth's popularity as a blogger is most attributable to his willingness to share his personal journey getting out of debt and his past full of financial mistakes, which many people can relate to. When he talked with Brad and Jonathan on the podcast, he shared the following insights: "You have to recognize that not everyone starts at the same place, and you're going to have bad things happen to you. But when the bad things happen, you have to have the resilience to say, OK, yeah this happened. It sucks, but I'm going to move forward and here's how I'm going to solve it."

Much of my solution to becoming happier and enjoying my homestretch to FI was the decision to use my investing and tax planning mistakes as inspiration to start writing about my own journey. I became a consumer advocate focused on helping others avoid repeating my experience, turning the negative into a positive expression of my passion for helping others.

Jonathan shared a similar theme when discussing his journey to overcome his six-figure student loan debt on the path to FI. Though he spent years working on getting out from under that debt, he said, "I don't regret my past decisions for a minute." Those